RECOVERY 04

ARA-290

Synthetic 11-amino-acid peptide (cibinetide), designed from part of erythropoietin (EPO)



CLASS	STUDIED FOR	HUMAN EVIDENCE	US STATUS
Peptide	Small-fiber nerve damage, pain	Small controlled trials (Phase 2)	Not FDA approved

STUDIED FOR

- **Nerve damage** — HUMAN + ANIMAL
- **Nerve pain** — HUMAN + ANIMAL
- **Blood sugar** — HUMAN
- **Diabetic eye swelling** — HUMAN

Developer-linked, small and short. Araim officers co-wrote several trials. No trial has tested it for muscle or sports injuries, and no Phase 3 trial has been run.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

ARA-290 ▶ Repair receptor ▶ Less inflammation ▶ Nerve protection

- **Designed from EPO,** but does not raise red blood cell production
- **Innate repair receptor:** the developer's described target
- **Tissue protection** and lower inflammation linked to it in animal studies
- **In people,** the mechanism is not established

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

CONTROLLED TRIALS
LEVEL 4 OF 5

- Phase 2b: 64 adults with sarcoidosis, 28 days
- Diabetes neuropathy RCT: 48 analyzed
- No Phase 3 trial

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Long-term safety
- Half-life in people
- Use for muscle or sports injury
- Drug interactions

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE	ROUTES STUDIED
Not established in people	Into a vein; injection under the skin (trials)
PHARMACOKINETICS	**SOLD AS**
Limited human data	Not approved; 503A nomination in category 3
MONITORED IN TRIALS	**SPORT (WADA)**
Nerve symptoms, corneal nerve fibers, HbA1c	Not named on the 2026 list; class S2.1.5 may apply

REGULATORY

FDA	Not approved; compounding category 3
HHS	Not in the Oct 2026 peptide policy
EMA	Orphan designations 2013, 2016; not authorised
WADA	Not named; S2.1.5 may apply

REFERENCES

1. Culver et al., ARA-290 Phase 2b in sarcoidosis, Invest Ophthalmol Vis Sci, May 2017
2. Brines et al., ARA-290 in type 2 diabetes, Mol Med, Mar 2015
3. WADA, 2026 Prohibited List

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